Cybersecurity Apprenticeship Journey

Final Presentation – Arab Bank (PTVA Management)

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Academic Mentor: *Shareef Shargawi*

Duration: *July 2025 – March 2026 (5 days/week)*

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البنك العربي
ARAB BANK
الوصول بداية

About Arab Bank & Mentorship

Company: *Leading financial institution emphasizing secure banking, compliance, and risk management.*

Mentors:

- ***Workplace:*** *Sari Abu Qoura & Zaid Al-Badawi.*
- ***Support:*** *Focused on technical PTVA workflows and enterprise security standards.*

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Full Apprenticeship Journey (8-Month Overview)

Phase 1

Foundation (FastAPI, Docker, Kubernetes).

Phase 2

Internal PT Support (Dev-sync & Scope definition).

Phase 3

External & Production Testing

Phase 4

Vulnerability Management (CMON, Tenable.SC, NeuVector).

1 2 3 4

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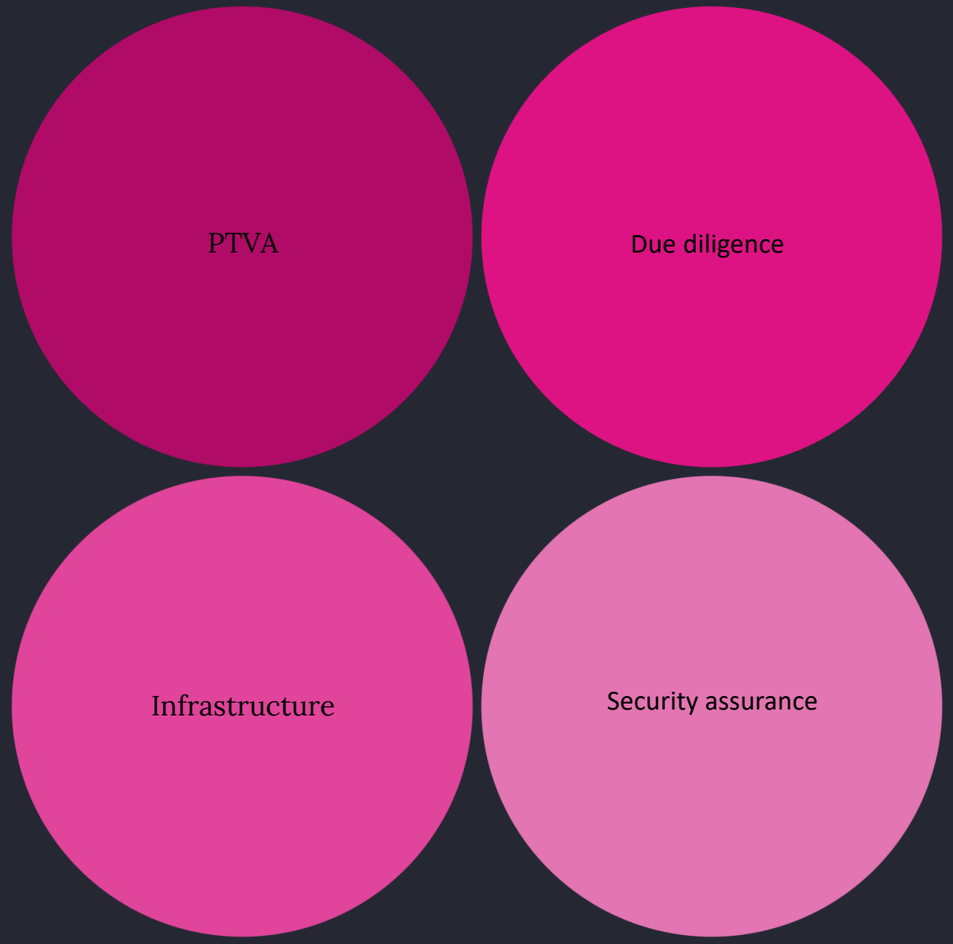
Departments Visited & Roles Held

Departments: *Security Assurance, PTVA, Network, Infrastructure, Due Diligence.*

Your Roles:

- *Penetration Testing Management Support.*
- *Compliance & Security Data Reviewer.*
- *Coordination & Reporting Liaison.*



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Roles Held

- Penetration testing management for internal applications.
- Coordinating testing schedules with app owners and external vendors.
- Monitoring and reporting endpoint compliance using CMON.
- Reviewing vulnerability scan reports and interpreting findings for further action.

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National Occupational Standards (NOSs)

1

Planning

PT scope & coordination (TECIS60442).

2

Identification

Threat & Vulnerability review (TECIS600201).

3

Teamwork

Collaboration with developers/vendors (SEMPMO221).

4

Implementation

VA workflow observation (TECDT61131).

5

Coding

API development with FastAPI (TECHDUCO1).

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Projects & Problem Solving (NDA Protected)

Note: *Detailed data protected by NDA.*

Key Contributions:

- *Managing Internal/External PT schedules.*
- *Resolving conflicts between Testers and Developers.*
- *Ensuring production environment stability during live tests.*
- *Improving compliance report accuracy.*

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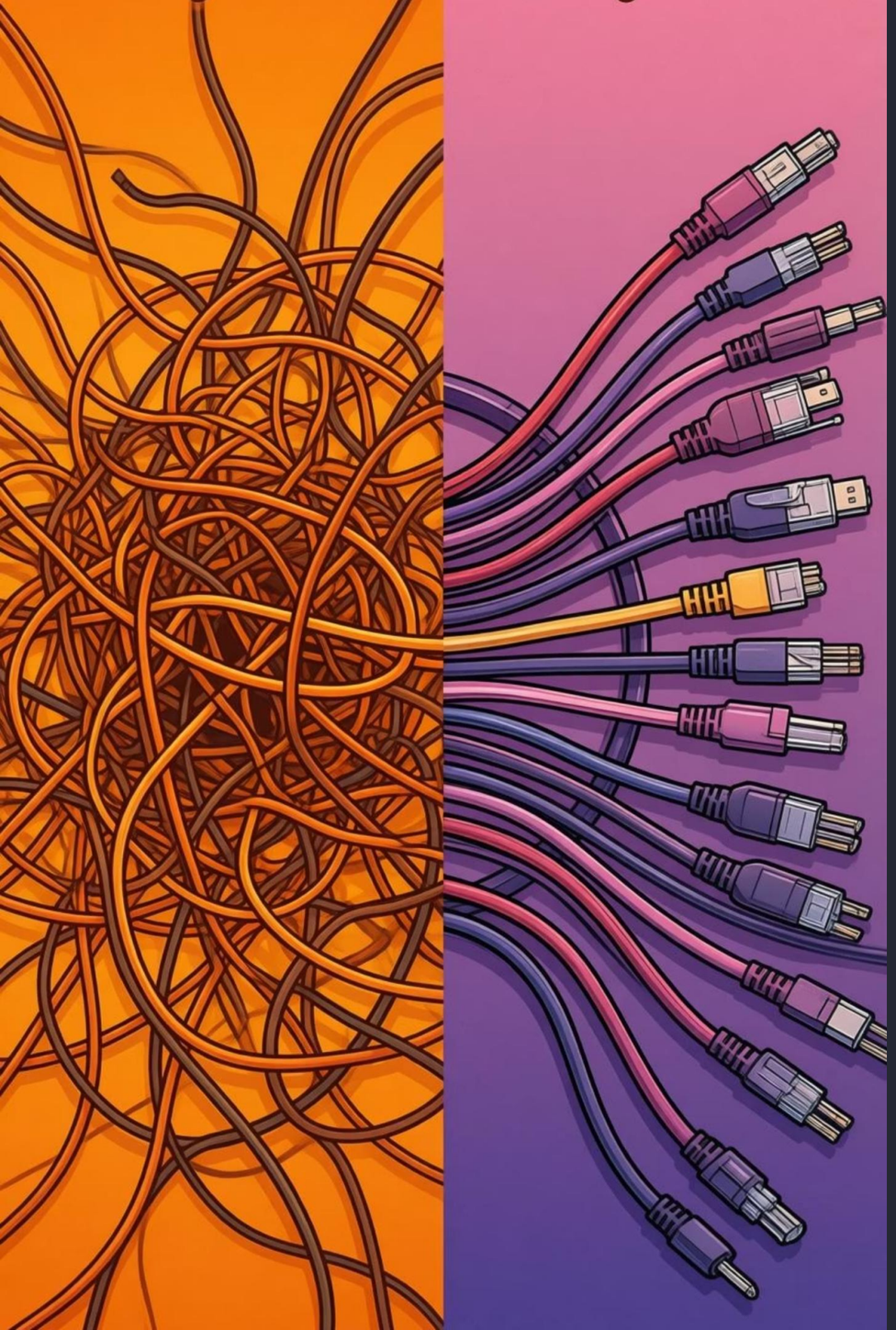

Challenges & Professional Growth

Challenges:

Limited tool access & complex cross-team communication.

Overcoming:

Used structured documentation, handover sessions, and escalation procedures.

Result: *Improved adaptability and communication skills in high-pressure environments.*

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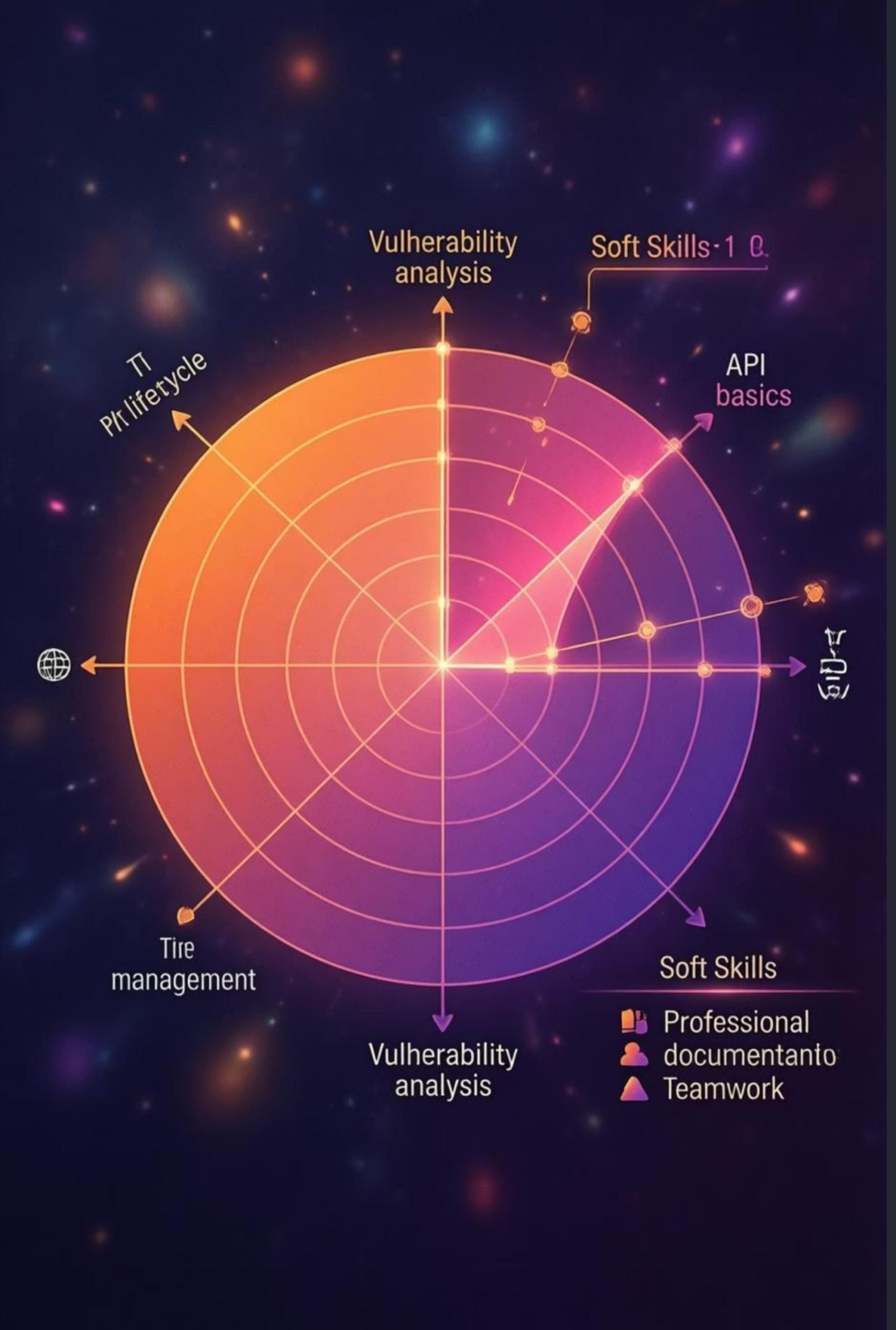

Reflection & Career Impact

Technical Skills:

- *PT lifecycle*
- *Vulnerability analysis*
- *API basics*

Soft Skills:

- *Time management*
- *Professional documentation*
- *Teamwork*

The Future: *Solidified interest in Offensive Security and Vulnerability Management.*

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Conclusion & Future Outlook

Summary: *A valuable experience bridging academic theory with real-world cybersecurity operations.*

Impact: *Enhanced professional readiness and enterprise security mindset.*

Status: *Building a strong foundation for a career in Penetration Testing.*

Thank You

Mohammad Hani Alshenaiwer

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